



dently while the other is charging in the case. Works like a charm.

As we said, a few features but well-implemented. The only major drawback is no app support on iOS, which means iPhone users cannot tweak the EQ, customise controls, or turn on Game Mode.

PERFORMANCE

Packing 12.4 mm titanised diaphragm drivers, the OnePlus Buds 2r serves up some booming bass response. Select OnePlus phones (7/7Pro/7T/7T Pro/8/8Pro/8T/9/9Pro/9R/9RT/10 Pro/11/11R) support Dolby Atmos sound. It's a shame that OnePlus didn't allow for Dolby Atmos support across all devices with compatibility which some budget TWS do have. I reviewed these earphones with the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra as the source device, so I couldn't test out Dolby content with these buds. The buds support the SBC and AAC codecs.

That aside, the buds have a bass-biased sound signature that is slightly similar to the Nord Buds 2. The bass response on the Nord Buds 2 is very slightly more pronounced in the sub-bass area than that of the Nord Buds 2r but the end result is pretty similar. The bass response is loud and impactful; pop, EDM, hip-hop and Bollywood dance tracks pack a punch but there is a bit of muddiness that shrouds the details in the mids.

Due to this vocals can get a bit lost in the mix. In the song Escapism. by RAYE & 079 Shake, the vocals lack detail and timbre in the pre-chorus. The highs are

weak in the mix – they lack character and depth but that's common at this price. There's some distortion in the audio when you push the volume levels above 80 per cent, so we suggest keeping it under that.

These earbuds are ones that bass-lovers will enjoy; audiophiles, not so much. OnePlus knows its audience though, and understands that most prefer a bass-heavy sound signature – so, for that, it's perfectly serviceable. The bass is not extra muddy, and the vocals, while muted, don't sound muffled.

The Nord Buds 2r feature dual microphones with AI noise cancellation. The mics are pretty decent; the user's voice is clear on calls but the microphones aren't able to effectively minimise ambient noise in calls.

BATTERY LIFE

I was impressed by the battery life of the OnePlus Nord Buds 2 and it's no different with the Buds 2r. While the Nord Buds 2 is capable of 36 hours of total battery life without ANC turned on, the Nord Buds 2r goes a step further with a whopping 38 hours of total playback time, according to OnePlus. The buds alone have a playback time of 8 hours on a single charge, which is excellent as well.

In our tests, the buds lasted 7 hours and 42 minutes on a single charge, which is close to OnePlus' estimate. The case provides 4 additional full charges with some juice left to spare. OnePlus strangely didn't mention fast charging, but in my experience, the buds charged about as fast as the Nord Buds 2. So, a

quick 5-minute charge provides almost an hour of playtime on the earbuds.

VERDICT

When OnePlus first intimated me about the OnePlus Nord Buds 2r and its pricing, I was a bit concerned. The pricing is extremely close to its older sibling (₹2,199 vs ₹2,999) and it was bound to drop features to lower the price. Thankfully, OnePlus hasn't dropped too many features – ANC being the only one of note – so the ₹900 price difference seems justified. In the budget TWS segment, a ₹900 difference is substantial. Additionally, the ANC on the older Nord Buds 2 isn't path-breaking. So, the OnePlus Nord Buds 2r is actually an excellent offering at this price that offers good bang for your buck. You get customisable controls and EQ, impressive battery life, and decent bass-forward sound which many will love. However, there are some misses – volume controls, lacking app support for iOS, and slightly inadequate fit which may stray users away from these.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 12.4 mm dynamic drivers | Driver sensitivity: 111 dB ± 3 dB | Frequency response: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | Microphones: Dual mics with AI noise cancellation | Battery life: 8 hours (earbuds only), 38 hours (earbuds with case) | Battery capacity: 35 mAh (earbuds), 480 mAh (case) | Weight: 4.3 g (each earbud), 38.1 g (case) | IP rating: IP55 | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Wireless range: 10 m | Gaming mode latency: 94 ms

CONTACT

Company: OnePlus | Phone: 1800 102 8411 | Email: onepluscare@oneplus.com | Website: <https://www.oneplus.in/>